eventually grows into a firm conviction which nothing can shake any more. This firm belief in the absolute *Real* in nature is what constitutes for him the given, self-evident premise of his work; it fortifies repeatedly his hope of eventually groping his way still a little nearer to the essence of objective Nature, and of thereby gaining further clues to her secrets.

Since the real world, in the absolute sense of the word, is independent of individual personalities, and in fact of all human intelligence, every discovery made by any individual acquires a completely universal significance. This gives the inquirer, wrestling with his problem in quiet seclusion, the assurance that every discovery will win the unhesitating recognition of all experts throughout the entire world, and in this feeling of the importance of his work lies his happiness. It compensates him fully for many a sacrifice which he must make in his daily life.

The sublime nature of such a goal must, necessarily, dwarf into insignificance any doubt engendered by the difficulties encountered while shaping the scientific world picture. It is particularly important to emphasize this in our own day, for nowadays such difficulties are sometimes regarded as serious impediments to the salutary progress of scientific work. It is an odd fact that experimental difficulties are so regarded to a lesser degree than theoretical ones. The circumstance that with the increasing demands on the accuracy of measurements the instruments, too, become more intricate, is understood and accepted as a matter of course. But the fact that in the endeavor to improve continually the expansion of systematic interrelations, it is necessary to use definitions and concepts which diverge more and more from traditional forms and intuitive notions, is sometimes cited as a reproach against theoretical research, and is even viewed as indicating that theoretical research is entirely on the wrong track.

Nothing could be more shortsighted than such a view. For if we stop to think that the improvement of the world picture goes hand in hand with an approach to the metaphysically “real world,” the expectation that the definitions and concepts of the objectively real world picture will not diverge too much from the framework created by the classical world picture, amounts basically to a demand that the metaphysically real world be completely intelligible in terms of ideas derived from the former naive world picture. This is a demand that can be never fulfilled. We simply cannot expect to recognize and discern the finer structure of something, so long as we flatly refuse to view it otherwise than with the naked eye. Yet, in this respect there is no reason for fear. The development of the scientific world picture is a matter of absolute necessity. The experiences gained with the refined instruments of measurement demand inexorably that certain firmly-rooted intuitive notions be abandoned and replaced by new, more abstract conceptual structures, for which the appropriate intuitions are still to be found and